CASE STUDY · MID-LEVEL DONOR ENGAGEMENT

A performing arts organization found major gift capacity below $350 in lifetime giving.

Wealth and affinity data said this overlooked segment could give. A relationship-first campaign proved it, with an average first-time gift of $2,390.



KEY RESULTS

2,067
DONORS SELECTED FOR ENGAGEMENT

1,026
DONORS ENGAGED

467
NEW GIFTS GENERATED

72%
INCREASE IN OVERALL GIVING

> *"Lifetime giving totals alone don't tell the whole story of a donor's capacity or loyalty."*
>
> The finding behind the campaign

The Challenge

The organization identified a donor segment with lifetime philanthropic giving under $350, even though public-domain wealth and affinity data suggested the audience had major giving potential that had never been cultivated. Catapult selected 2,067 of them for personalized engagement, prioritizing the strongest indicators of connection to the mission.

The Strategy

Outreach led with connection and impact rather than an ask: identify each donor's personal reason for caring about the mission, introduce the tangible impact of the work, add value to the donor's experience, and reinforce why their support matters before soliciting a gift.

The Results

- 1,026 donors engaged through the campaign
- 467 new gifts generated from a previously overlooked segment
- Overall giving from the segment rose 72%
- Average gift size rose between 61% and 135%, depending on segment
- Average first-time gift from non-donors in the segment: $2,390

$2,390
AVERAGE FIRST-TIME GIFT

+61-135%
AVERAGE GIFT SIZE BY SEGMENT

WHY IT WORKED

- Data flagged capacity the giving history hid
- Impact came first, the ask came last
- Affinity decided who got called

Catapult FUNDRAISING

Catapult Fundraising | Offices in Nevada · New Jersey · Texas | (702) 508-0101 | info@catapultfr.com | www.catapultfr.com